

「1 級リスニングテスト」 原稿

ただいまから、1 級リスニングテストを行います。これからお話しすることについて質問は受けませんので、よく注意して聞いてください。このテストでは、テストの方法と注意事項がすべて英語で放送されます。

The listening test for the Grade 1 examination is about to begin. Listen carefully to the directions. You will not be permitted to ask questions during the test.

This test has four parts. All of the questions in these four parts are multiple-choice questions. For each question, choose the best answer from among the four choices written in your test booklet. On your answer sheet, find the number of the question and mark your answer. You are permitted to take notes for every part of this listening test.

Now, here are the directions for **Part 1**. In this part, you will hear 10 dialogues, **No. 1** through **No. 10**. Each dialogue will be followed by one question. For each question, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The dialogue and the question will be given only once. Now, let's begin.

(★=男性 A ★★=男性 B ☆=女性 A ☆☆=女性 B)

★No. 1

☆☆: Jim, did you hear the latest? Margaret is being promoted to accounting supervisor.

★★: What? You've got to be kidding.

☆☆: It's right here in the memo. She starts her new duties on June 1.

★★: That's got to be the worst news I've had all year. She's so bad-tempered.

☆☆: Tell me about it. She jumped all over me the other day just because I needed some information from her for my weekly report.

★★: Well, maybe it's time for me to start looking for another job. Anything to avoid having Margaret for a boss.

★Question: Why is the man upset?

★★No. 2

★: How was the negotiating seminar you went to last month?

☆: I learned so much. Wish I hadn't wasted so many years trying to learn this stuff on my own. The trainers really knew what they were doing.

★: Have you had a chance to put your new skills into practice yet?

☆: As a matter of fact, I just closed a deal with a big electronics manufacturer. The stuff I learned at the seminar made a big difference.

★★Question: What does the woman imply?

☆☆No. 3

☆: Look at this TV ad, George. That vegetable cutter can cut, slice, and dice just about anything.

★★: If it really worked, it would be selling well in regular stores.

☆: Why are you always such a cynic?

★★: My father bought something like that once, but he could never get it to work.

☆: That was years ago. Things are more advanced now.

★★: Only the promotion methods! But if you really want it, get it.

☆: No, because if it breaks, I'll never hear the end of it.

☆☆**Question:** What do we learn from this conversation?

☆**No. 4**

☆☆: Neil, look at my shoes! Maggie's dog chewed them up while I was having coffee at her house.

★: How did the dog get your shoes?

☆☆: They were by the front door. I took them off because Maggie had just polished her floors. Should I ask her to pay for a new pair?

★: Well, I know they're your favorite shoes, but Maggie's your best friend. You don't want to ruin your friendship, do you?

☆☆: You're right. And she did apologize. It's just really annoying having to go replace them.

☆**Question:** What does the man suggest the woman do?

★**No. 5**

☆☆: Federal Airlines. How may I help you?

★★: Yes, I have 11,500 miles in my mileage account, and I'd like to use them up. Could you tell me my options?

☆☆: Well, you can upgrade to business class on most domestic flights. That requires 10,000 miles. Some restrictions apply, though.

★★: How about using the miles for a flight?

☆☆: You don't have enough for an entire fare. However, if you pay \$250 and cash in 10,000 miles, you can fly economy on any flight within the continental U.S. until March 30.

★★: Thanks. I'll think about it.

★**Question:** What does the woman tell the man?

★★**No. 6**

☆: The Dawsons' summer house was gorgeous, wasn't it? What do you think of us doing something like that?

★: I don't know. We'd have to worry about maintaining another home, and we'd have less money to spend on traveling.

☆: Still, it might be a good investment. I've been doing a little research about it.

★: From what I've read, the second-home market is more volatile than first homes. And remember property taxes.

☆: Can you at least give it some thought? We don't really travel that much anyway, you know.

★: OK. I'll talk to some people at work and see what they think.

★★**Question:** What would the woman like the man to do?

☆☆**No. 7**

☆: Tom, long time, no see. How's everything with your new job at the ad company?

★★: In one word, stressful. The majority of ads I create are for engineers, so I have to get all the technical details right, and that's not easy.

☆: And I guess you have a lot of tight deadlines.

★★: Yes, but that's nothing new. The problem is I have to do a lot more research now, too.

☆: You always did great work at RCB Graphics, so I'm sure you'll get used to it soon.

★★: Thanks. I hope you're right.

☆☆**Question:** What is the man's concern?

☆**No. 8**

☆☆: Bill, have you seen the three-month economic forecast?

★: I sure did. It looks pretty upbeat, doesn't it? Unemployment is predicted to drop by a full percentage point.

☆☆: I wish I could share your enthusiasm. Most of the jobs created will be low hourly-wage positions in the service sector.

★: That's true, but at least more people will have jobs. That's sure better than being out of work, isn't it?

☆☆: I still think that people won't really be that much better off. How would you like to work for the minimum wage?

☆**Question:** What do the man and woman mainly disagree about?

★**No. 9**

☆: What's the matter, honey?

★★: It's our utility bills. I know it was a really cold winter, but they're almost 20 percent more than they were at our previous house. And that's despite us turning down the thermostat and dressing warmly.

☆: We could take other measures. Buy energy-efficient products, maybe put extra insulation in the attic. A guy at work reduced his heating bill by 30 percent that way.

★★: I'm not sure that would really work with this old place. We may just have to accept that this is a cold house.

☆: Well, this might seem ambitious, but we could always think more long-term and look at solar panels.

★★: I'd like to do that eventually, but the initial cost would put too much strain on our finances.

☆: Dana next door is looking into it. Apparently, there are some government subsidies and tax write-offs that would bring the costs down a bit.

★★: Yeah, I've heard that, but the initial expense still worries me.

☆: I read that some systems generate enough power to sell back to the electricity company. It could even be a financial gain in the long run.

★★: Hmm . . . I'm not so sure. Let's look into it when we're in a better financial position than the one we're in now.

★**Question:** What does the man think about solar panels?

★★**No. 10**

☆: So, Dan, what do you think of the candidates we've interviewed so far?

★: I think Philip Johnson could be a good addition to our team.

☆: Mary?

☆☆: Hmm . . . I'm not sure. Philip's still young, which is a plus, I guess, since he can grow with the job . . .

★: He also graduated from a good university, and he has some sales experience in our industry. Hopefully, that means he'd require less training.

☆: I guess so, but Philip seems too quiet and shy. I have to say, none of the interviewees

seemed really outstanding. There's no one who's really "wowed" me.

☆☆: I agree. We haven't seen a candidate with a proven track record of boosting sales. We're looking for someone who's proactive, someone who can expand our customer base.

☆: I know it's a lot of work, but personally I'd rather continue this process in the hopes of finding a candidate who meets all our criteria.

★: I still think someone like Philip is worth considering.

☆: Look, why don't we keep him as a backup for now? Meanwhile, Dan, can you let our recruiting agencies know the position is still open?

★: OK, if you're sure. I'll also let them know that the rest didn't make the grade.

★★**Question:** What do the two women think?

Here are the directions for **Part 2**. In this part, you will hear five passages, (A) through (E). Each passage will be followed by two questions, **No. 11** through **No. 20**. For each question, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The passage and the questions will be given only once. Now, let's begin.

☆☆(A) *New Findings on Exercise*

Medical evidence shows that regular, moderate exercise improves longevity and reduces the risk of heart disease. But fewer than 20 percent of Americans manage the officially recommended 150 minutes of moderate exercise per week. Now, though, supporters of "high-intensity interval training" claim a busy lifestyle is no excuse for being out of shape. The pioneer of this method was Professor Martin Gibala. He carried out a study in which subjects had to pedal hard on an exercise bike for 30 seconds, take a short rest, and then repeat the process five or six times. He found that such workouts had an effect on the body equivalent to two hours of gentle bike riding.

Such high-intensity interval training has been shown to improve fitness levels, but most health professionals believe that it is too early to change the official guidance on exercise. Because all the studies so far have been short-term studies, serious questions remain about whether the workouts will be as effective as other types of workouts in promoting longevity. In addition, most studies have been carried out on young men, and there are concerns about whether high-intensity workouts are suitable for women or older people.

★**Questions**

★**No.11** What did Professor Martin Gibala's research show?

★**No.12** What do health professionals believe about high-intensity interval training?

★★(B) *Bees*

When bees fly through the air, they bump into millions of tiny particles. The resulting friction causes the bees to acquire a positive electrical charge. Flowers, on the other hand, naturally have a negative charge. When a bee lands on a flower to remove nectar, the flower's electrical charge weakens. Recently, researchers found that bees can detect the strength or weakness of a flower's electrical field while in flight. The researchers say that bees use this skill to find flowers that are less likely to have been visited by other bees, and are therefore more likely to have nectar.

In a laboratory experiment, researchers filled a room with metal disks, half of which contained sugar water given a negative electric charge. The other disks, which contained a different liquid, had no charge. Bees flew to the charged disks more than 80 percent of the time. When researchers removed the charges, however, the bees visited the disks randomly,

finding the sugar water only by chance. This experiment appears to confirm the researchers' belief that bees do indeed have more sensory tools than scientists were previously aware of.

☆Questions

☆No. 13 What is one thing that researchers have recently found?

☆No. 14 What happened when electrical charges were removed in the laboratory experiment?

☆(C) *The Limits of Anonymity*

Some people feel the Internet gives them the right to comment on anything while keeping their identities hidden. But a recent legal case in the U.S. could change that perception. A district court judge in Idaho ordered a news blog to name the reader who wrote an anonymous remark about a local politician. The judge ruled that the comment damaged the politician's reputation by suggesting she had stolen money. The judge said the law gives people the right to anonymous free speech, but it does not allow them to make unproven accusations about others.

In light of this ruling, some news websites now require people to submit their contact information before commenting on an article. Other sites use a system that gives preference to comments written by readers who use their real names. Another reason news websites are making these changes is that discussions between anonymous readers often become abusive or offensive. News website owners fear this is scaring away advertisers, who do not want to pay for space next to such remarks. They also believe that encouraging people to identify themselves will build trust among readers.

★★Questions

★★No. 15 What did the district court judge in Idaho decide?

★★No. 16 What is one thing that some news websites are now doing?

★(D) *Marijuana*

Marijuana contains a compound called THC, and THC's mind-altering properties are the reason marijuana is illegal in many places. However, some medical researchers have long believed that marijuana also has medicinal properties. More than two decades ago, experiments on mice suggested that THC has the effect of slowing the growth of cancerous tumors. In a subsequent study in 2007, THC reduced the number of lung tumors in mice by 60 percent. The study's researchers believe THC does this by blocking the creation of blood vessels within tumors.

Many mainstream medical authorities, though, remain reluctant to approve the use of marijuana as a cancer drug beyond prescribing it to treat pain, loss of appetite, and nausea. They argue that the evidence it can fight cancer is not compelling. Furthermore, they are concerned that if marijuana is used, patients may delay the use of long and painful—but more effective—conventional treatments. Nevertheless, some researchers are pursuing the creation of a synthetic version of THC that lacks mind-altering properties. They are optimistic that such a variant will one day be a legal and effective form of cancer treatment.

☆☆Questions

☆☆No. 17 What did the 2007 study suggest about THC?

☆☆No. 18 What are some researchers hoping to do?

☆☆(E) *Natural Capital*

Before governments and companies make decisions about development projects that may affect the environment, they usually conduct an analysis based on direct economic costs

and benefits. However, some conservationists believe that such calculations underestimate the benefits gained from so-called natural capital. Natural capital refers to assets from nature, such as water, air, land, and wood. According to conservationist Jonathan Hughes, the value of a mangrove forest in Malaysia, for example, is usually based on the amount that the land could be sold for on the open market. Hughes, however, argues that the protection which mangroves offer from hurricanes and tsunamis makes them worth 20 times their market value.

Scotland has become the first place to attempt to accurately value its natural capital. The government has brought together public, private, and voluntary organizations to do this. Supporters hope it will lead to sustainable natural-resource management practices that will preserve these assets for future generations. Some critics, however, fear that if publicly owned areas such as national parks are given a monetary value, the government will allow such areas to be sold off. Others simply believe that the value of nature can never really be measured in monetary terms.

★★Questions

★★No. 19 What does Jonathan Hughes say about mangrove forests?

★★No. 20 Why are some critics opposed to Scotland's initiative?

Here are the directions for **Part 3**. In this part, you will hear five passages, (F) through (J). The passages represent real-life situations and may contain sound effects. Each passage will have one question, **No. 21** through **No. 25**. Before each passage, you will have 10 seconds to read the situation and question written in your test booklet. After you hear the passage, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The passage will be given only once. Now, let's begin.

☆(F) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 21.

★Benham's annual Autumn Sale starts today! In addition to unbeatable prices on home appliances, we'll be hosting some spectacular events you don't want to miss. At the end of the week, there will be a lottery drawing for a four-day, all-expenses-paid vacation in beautiful Acapulco, Mexico. Customers who have made home-appliance purchases of \$500 or more in the last month are also eligible to participate. To receive your entry ticket, just show your receipt at the Autumn Sale table, located near our store entrance. Customers who make purchases during the Autumn Sale will also receive a coupon. This coupon is good for 10 percent off any regularly priced item in the store. Any Autumn Sale purchase over \$900 also qualifies you to receive a complimentary Supermatic Blender, which you can pick up at the Customer Service counter.

☆Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

★★(G) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 22.

☆Here's what's to come this afternoon at the Winding River Literary Festival. At 12:30 in the Rouge Room, teacher Lynn Chan will be giving a one-hour presentation for beginners on the art of the short story. The presentation will include readings from her award-winning pieces. A two-hour poetry session will start at the same time in Grace Gardens. Aspiring poets are encouraged to join this. At 1 p.m. in the Big Tent, the festival's pitching session will begin. At this session, participants have five minutes to convince a panel of publishers' agents to publish their work. Pre-registration is required at the sign-in desk in the Big Tent, and there are still a few slots left. Finally, at three o'clock in the Hume Lounge, industry analyst Howard Rakov will discuss the changing face of publishing, including tips on self-publishing.

★★Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

☆☆(H) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 23.

★★There are several possibilities for what's making Charlie sick. For one, if he's only restricted to the house, it could be an allergy to something in his food. In that case, you might try switching to a prescription diet. A one-month supply is \$100. We could also run some tests to determine the exact allergen, but they're pricey—\$300. Now, if he's been outside, he probably caught rodents or small birds. In that case, it's more likely that he has a parasitic infection. You could expect to pay about \$100 to test for that, and if it were to come back positive, we'd use a broad-spectrum antibiotic to remove the parasite. This would cost an additional \$80. There's also a small chance he has a bacterial infection, but that's difficult to confirm without more extensive testing, which would add up to \$250.

☆☆Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

★(I) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 24.

☆☆The traditional 4-S plan, which you have all probably heard of, is only available for company employees, not the self-employed. There are, however, several other tax-favorable options available. The LLP plan resembles a traditional 4-S in that you have the option to borrow from your account in emergencies. While it allows high contributions, it's restricted to one contributor only. The Active-3 plan is a useful plan for self-employed business owners and their spouses to contribute to. It's also possible to borrow money using this plan, but you should only do this if you're really struggling, as you will lose some benefits. Finally, the Savings Match plan offers the best interest rates, but the downside is that you cannot borrow money from it, and only the plan-holder can contribute.

★Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

☆☆(J) You have 10 seconds to read the situation and Question No. 25.

★I know you hope to move on and become a sales manager, but that requires at least four years' experience as a sales rep. So, for the next year, you should work on getting your numbers up. OK, let's look at some of the details. You're meeting your monthly sales quota 85 percent of the time, which is pretty good. You've mainly gone after new clients and achieved a reasonable number of first-time sales. Your efforts to improve your product expertise have also paid off here, as first-time clients appreciate communicating with someone who has such knowledge. However, your sales to existing customers are below target. I think that building stronger relationships with them would push your overall sales beyond your monthly quota. By doing that, you'll be in a better position to get a promotion next year.

☆☆Now mark your answer on your answer sheet.

Finally, here are the directions for **Part 4**. In this part, you will hear an interview. The interview will be followed by two questions, **No. 26** and **No. 27**. For each question, you will have 10 seconds to choose the best answer and mark your answer on your answer sheet. The interview and the questions will be given only once.

★★Now let's listen to the interview. This is an interview with Peter Joyce, who is an operations manager for a water company in the U.K.

Interviewer (I): Peter, thank you for coming to the studio.

Peter Joyce (PJ): Great, it's a pleasure.

I: Could you briefly tell us what you do?

PJ: I'm an operations manager for a water company in the U.K.

I: What are the biggest issues facing the water supply business at the moment?

PJ: The biggest one for us is probably competition at the moment. So we've got some new regulations going through Parliament which will bring in competition. So all of the water companies act on a monopoly basis at the moment, so they each have their different part of the country that they can sell water to. Competition will open up completely, so it means we compete with each other. And that's a real challenge, 'cause each water company will have to operate differently, and we're, we have to allow other companies to come in and potentially run our network, which obviously we don't want them to do.

I: So they could come in, and they could utilize the same network of pipes that you guys put in?

PJ: Yeah, they could.

I: What effect does environmental pollution have on your company's work?

PJ: The biggest impact is more so on the water, water abstraction side, so we have to be very careful about that, water not getting polluted. So if there was any chemicals or oil or anything like that got into the water table, it could get into our water pipes and into water supply. So we've got to be very careful about that, and we never get that water to the people's houses if we thought it was contaminated in any way.

I: Do you think current water consumption levels are sustainable?

PJ: No, actually, in short, I don't think they are. Because we had a drought last year and it kind of showed the vulnerability in some of the, the areas, particularly where, where I work in East Anglia. So we're doing a lot of work with our customers, particularly the industrial customers, to try and get them to use water in a different way and conserve it better.

I: What other programs do you have in place to encourage water conservation?

PJ: Well, we've got one called Drop Twenty, which we've tried to push with our domestic customers, so our, our, just household customers, and it's basically saying, can you reduce your water use by 20 liters a day? And the best way to do it is really simple things, like turn the tap off when you clean your teeth, or don't have a shower for so long, so time your shower, which sounds a bit strange but you have a little sort of music playing, and then when it stops you have to get out. And things like that just to encourage people to think "oh, right, OK, I'm perhaps using too much," just—and it's amazing what you can reduce with just little things.

I: I understand that you're involved in an interesting conversion project. Could you tell us a little bit about that?

PJ: Yes, that's up in Grimsby, which is a, a town in the north, and we've got what we call a combined heat and power plant. And that basically treats human waste. So it's, it's a gas called methane that comes off of that plant, and we recycle that. We turn it into electricity, and that goes out into people's houses, and it can obviously light their homes. It's, it's, the process that we do to create that gas is something called anaerobic digestion. That's something that happens in a tank, so we put all the waste into a tank, and there's no oxygen in there, but we heat it up, and that causes it to break down into its constituent parts, so carbon, and methane, and things like that. And that's what we use, then, for our heat and power engines.

I: All right. Well, Peter, thank you very much for coming in to the studio today.

PJ: Thank you, it was a pleasure.

★★Questions:

★★No.26 What is one issue Peter says the water supply business is facing?

★★No.27 What is one thing Peter says regarding the conversion project?

Your time is up. Stop writing and wait quietly until the answer sheets have been collected.

では、時間です。筆記用具を置いて答えの記入をやめてください。試験監督者に連絡いたします。これより最終の受験者数を確認してください。その後、解答用紙を回収し枚数の確認を行ってく

ださい。なお、問題冊子は回収しません。受験者数と解答用紙の枚数の一致を確認してから、解散の指示を出してください。受験者の皆さんは、身のまわりをよく点検し、忘れものがないように注意してください。受験者の皆さんが退出するときは、別の教室が試験中の場合もありますので、声を出さず、校舎出口まで静かに退出してください。それでは、解散の指示を出すまで静かにお待ちください。